Pickleball Feasibility Analysis

Prepared by Leisure Analytics
Site-specific advisory & market assessment

LEISURE ANALYTICS

Executive Summary

Project Overview

[redacted] is considering existing sports facility, [redacted], Arundel, as a potential pickleball court facility. Leisure Analytics was hired by [redacted] to determine the current and future demand for a hypothetical pickleball court in Arundel and the associated capital and operating costs.

This study answers the following questions:

- What is the demographic profile of pickleball enthusiasts (age, income, educational attainment, etc.)?
- How many pickleball enthusiasts (play at least once per month or would like to play if facilities were located locally) live in the Trade Area?
- How many potential pickleball enthusiasts live within a 15-minute drive of one or more potential pickleball court locations within the Trade Area?
- How many pickleball venues exist within a 20-minute drive of one or more potential pickleball court locations within the Trade Area? What share of these facilities are council operated?
- How many and in what locations are there proposed pickleball venues and when are they likely to come online?
- What is the capital cost to develop pickleball courts (either from scratch or adaptively reusing existing court surfaces such as basketball or tennis)?

Figure 1. Prospective Pickleball Venue Trade Area

Key Findings & Recommendations

The following are the key findings generated from our high-level market and case study analysis:

Based on the benchmark dataset of dedicated QLD pickleball venues, Arundel's service level sits broadly in line with the state average but still reflects relatively tight dedicated venue provision relative to its age weighted demand base.

Across the QLD benchmark sample, the average provision equates to [redacted] dedicated venues per 1,000 relevant residents, with observed ratios ranging from [redacted] in Noosa, representing the highest relative demand concentration, to [redacted] in Gloucester, representing the lowest relative demand concentration. Arundel records [redacted] dedicated venues per 1,000 relevant residents, placing it marginally above the benchmark average and well below the highest supply markets.

[redacted]

Market Analysis

Pickleball Overview

Industry Growth

Pickleball Australia is the national governing body for the sport of pickleball and provides players with official rules, tournaments, rankings, and promotional materials. According to Clearninghouse, the information and knowledge sharing platform for Australian sport, pickleball is the fastest-growing sport in Australia, as of the six months to December 2025. The sport, which is a cross between table tennis, badminton, and tennis, was invented by three vacationers on Bainbridge Island, near Seattle, in 1965.

Pickleball User Profile

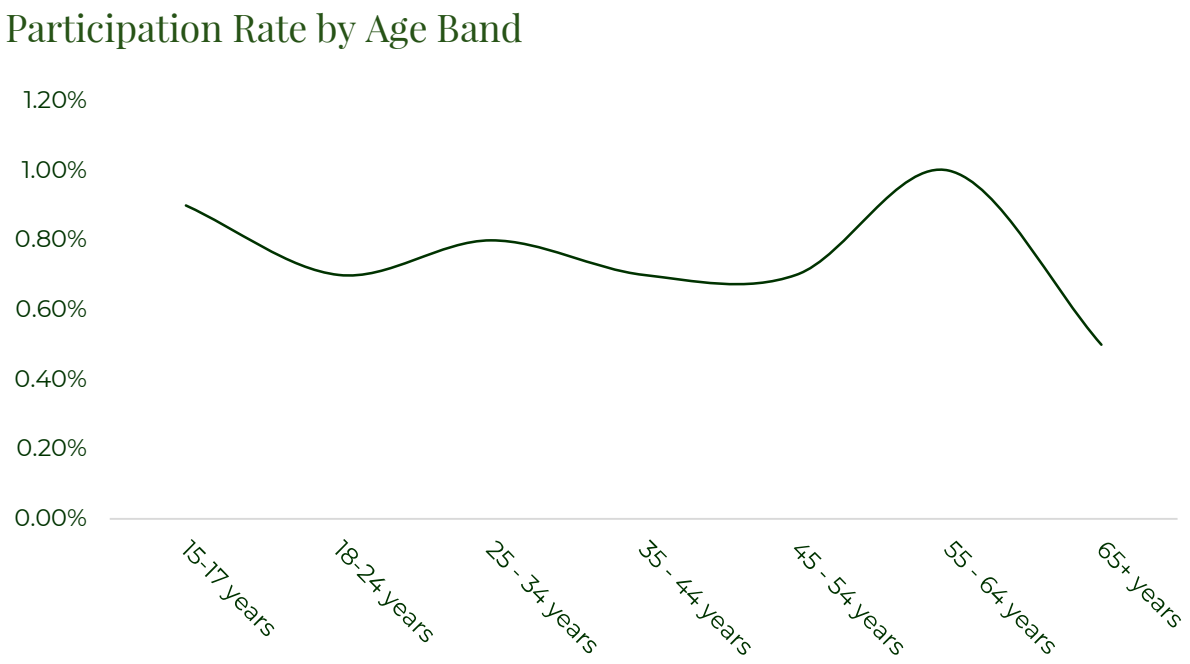
National Survey

The following summarizes key demographic characteristics of Australian's who have played pickleball or have interest in playing, according to Clearninghouse.

Gender: Women are more likely than men to have played pickleball or have interest in playing. Women made up 53 percent of pickleball players in 2025, while men made up 47 percent.

Age: Adults aged over 56 represent the cohort most likely to have played pickleball or have interest in playing. The average age of avid players is 34.

Figure 2. Share of Australians Who Have Played Pickleball, 2025



High-Level Socio-Economic Analysis

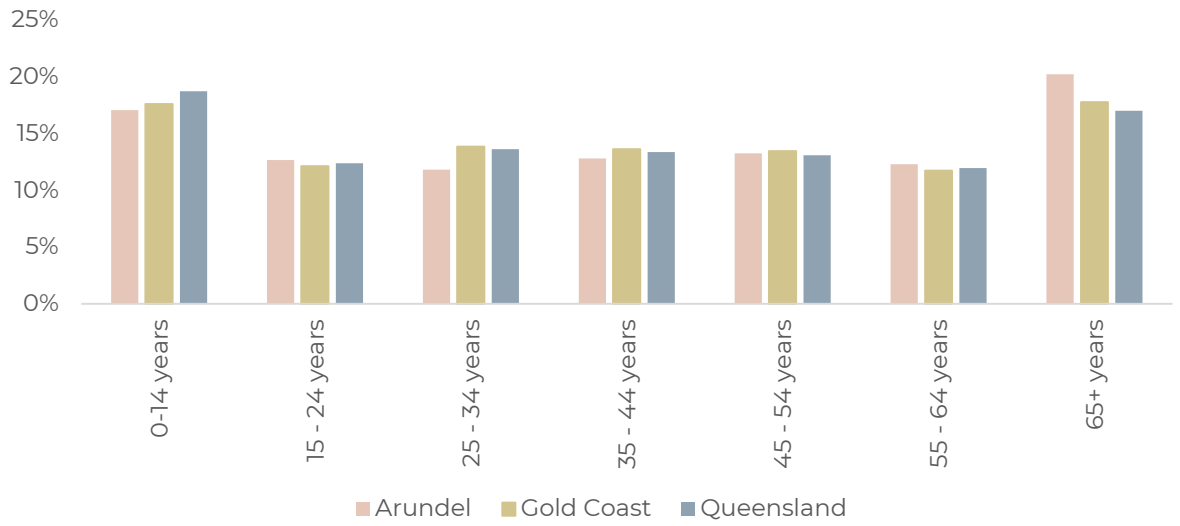
Total Population

The participation rate is not a reliable metric to model those who would play pickleball at a new facility. Because the participation rate only factors in where venues are currently built, and the number of people that have played versus the entire population. Actual participation increases when supply increases. We have adopted the (30%) interest in pickleball rate.

Population by Age

The age profile of the custom Arundel trade area skews slightly older than both the Gold Coast and Queensland benchmarks. Residents aged 65 years and over account for 20% of the trade area's population, compared to 18% across the Gold Coast and 17% statewide. Conversely, younger working-age cohorts are modestly under-represented, with residents aged 25 to 34 comprising 12% of the custom trade area's population, versus 14% across both the Gold Coast and Queensland. Middle-aged cohorts (35 to 54 years) are broadly aligned with benchmark distributions, indicating a stable core household base. Overall, the custom Arundel trade area demographic structure suggests relatively stronger demand drivers from older residents, with implications for leisure and recreation offerings that cater to established and senior-oriented participation rather than youth-led growth.

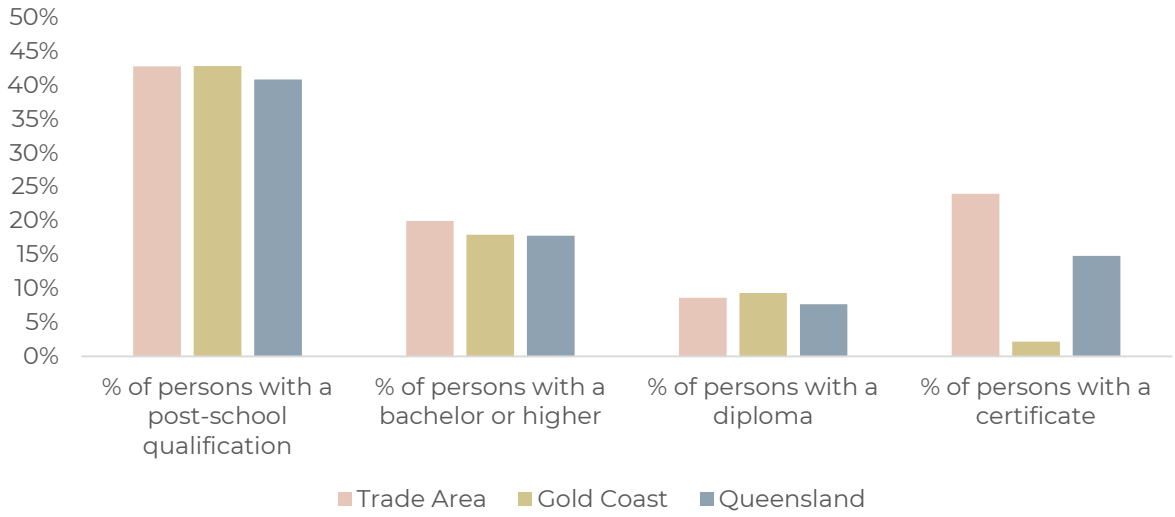
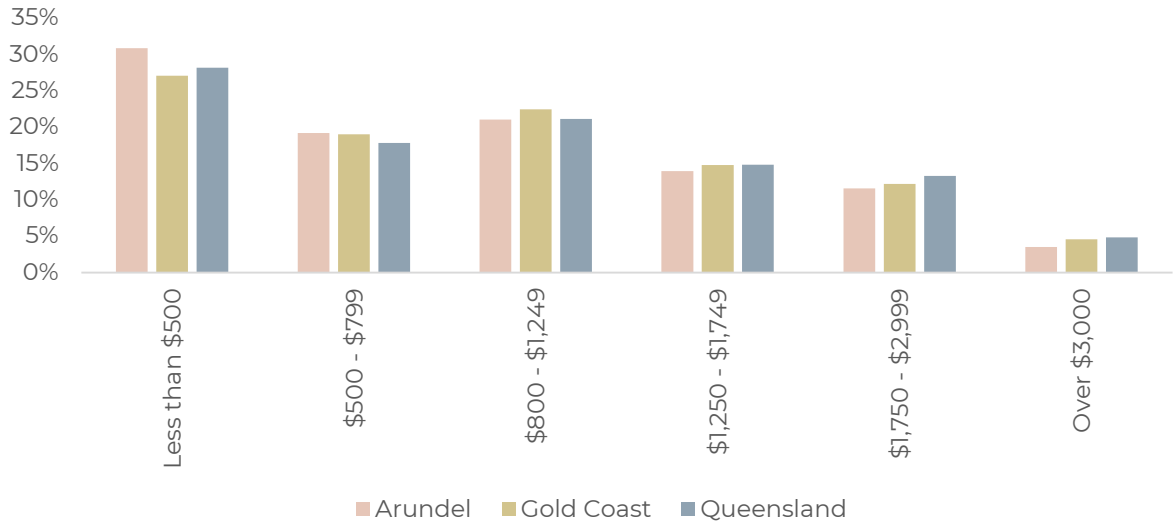
Age bracket (% of population)
Trade Area v LGA v QLD



Educational Attainment & Income Levels

[redacted]

Educational Attainment



Median Household Income